

world you don't need to worry about getting tired or even walking for that matter. You could simply fly around! No need to worry about food or stay, you're already at home. Of course, we're not implying that a virtual experience could compare to the real deal as the tech stands right now, but over time it will become difficult to tell the two apart. Other than that, VR would also be a great way to experience locations you might not otherwise travel to, like the peak of Mt. Everest for example. Not everyone can actually make the trip to the peak of the highest mountain in the world, but with VR you can.



SHOPPING

Most of the world has gotten used to online shopping. While there are many pros to online shopping, it has its cons too. Being unable to know if what you're purchasing is going to fit you, for example. With VR, you would be able to view a product from all angles. The product could also be to scale, so you would get a better idea of whether it's the right size for you. In time, with VR you would be able to virtually visit the physical store, looking at items there in real time.

VR IN THE WORKPLACE

Thanks to the pandemic, there was a large shift with lots of companies shifting to working from home. Even after lockdowns eased around the world, work from home has kind of become a preference for many. To



that end, VR can help maintain a work environment from the comfort of your home. There are already VR tools that exist to emulate conference rooms, so you can speak to your co-workers face-to-face and interact directly with them, rather than through a zoom call. There has also been talk of creating projects which can emulate senses other than sight and sound in VR, we're talking about being able to taste, smell and feel temperature in VR. This is still a concept though, but it's assumed that by 2030 we might actually be able to enter virtual worlds where all five of our senses would work.



This is still only the surface of workplace VR. Projects where you need to design anything from components to buildings can make use of VR to look at 3D models in detail and interact directly with the models before actually sending them to production. Think automotive manufacturing and architecture. You can take cars for test drives and virtually explore buildings before they're even constructed to get a better idea of the details.

There might eventually come a time when we won't have any other hardware other than the VR headset. Once we wear the headset, we'd have

all the tools we'd need at our fingertips in the virtual world.

Additionally, VR has uses in the military and rescue, such as piloting drones remotely for instance, and being able to see what the drone is seeing. Armed forces around the world have considered VR simulators to train their soldiers, much like NASA does for its astronauts. This can prepare troops for environments they may not necessarily be accustomed to.

SOCIALISING

We already have a few VR social platforms where people can meet up and interact with each other. This includes VR Chat, AltspaceVR, Rec Room and more. As VR becomes more mainstream and is adopted by the masses, not only will these platforms grow, but a lot more such platforms will start cropping up. Facebook's recent switch to Meta relies a lot on mass adoption of VR in order to see its vision become a reality.

Social interaction online can come very close to the real deal with VR. It makes sense, if every other aspect of our lives can make the virtual transition, so can socialisation.

These are just a few of the many uses of VR outside of gaming. There are still many industries that could benefit from incorporating VR in the future, and we're already seeing a lot of them do so successfully. We've only listed a few examples in this story, and we're sure there are many more. So reach out to us at editor@digit.in and let us know what your favourite application of VR is outside of gaming and media consumption! 